

CROCODILE LIZARD

The crocodile lizard is the only representative of the Shinisauridae. There are two recognized sub-species found in China and northern Vietnam. This little-studied lizard is endangered because of the popularity of the lizards as pets.



46 cm
18 in

CHINESE CROCODILE LIZARD

Shinisaurus crocodilurus crocodilurus

Restricted to the Guangxi region of S. China, this aquatic lizard feeds on fish and tadpoles. It basks on riverside bushes.

XENOSAURS

Found mainly in Mexico, these unusual lizards have the top of their head roughened by conical osteoderms (bony deposits) beneath the scales. The Xenosauridae bear live offspring and protect them in burrows. They prey on insects and other animals.



25 cm
10 in

KNOB-SCALED LIZARD

Xenosaurus grandis

A flat-bodied lizard found on the floor of Mexican rainforests, it feeds on flying insects at night. It remains hidden during the day.

NIGHT LIZARDS

The 30 or so Xantusiidae species are restricted to North and Central America. These secretive, viviparous lizards are crepuscular (active at twilight) or diurnal rather than nocturnal. They have a large headshield and rectangular belly scales.



13 cm
5 in

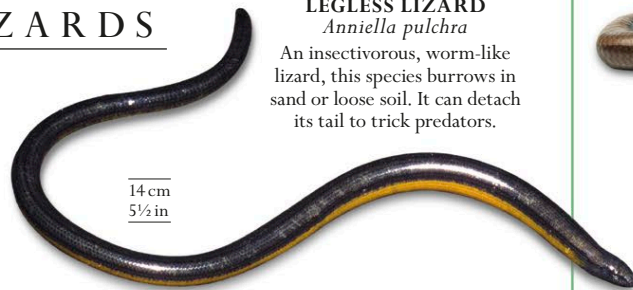
YELLOW-SPOTTED NIGHT LIZARD

Lepidophyma flavimaculatum

Found among rotting logs in the wet forests of C. America, this species feeds on insects.

AMERICAN LEGLESS LIZARDS

Found only in the deserts of western North America, the Anniellidae comprises two species. They have a long, cylindrical body and a small head, and burrow to hunt invertebrates. They give birth to one or two live young.



14 cm
5½ in

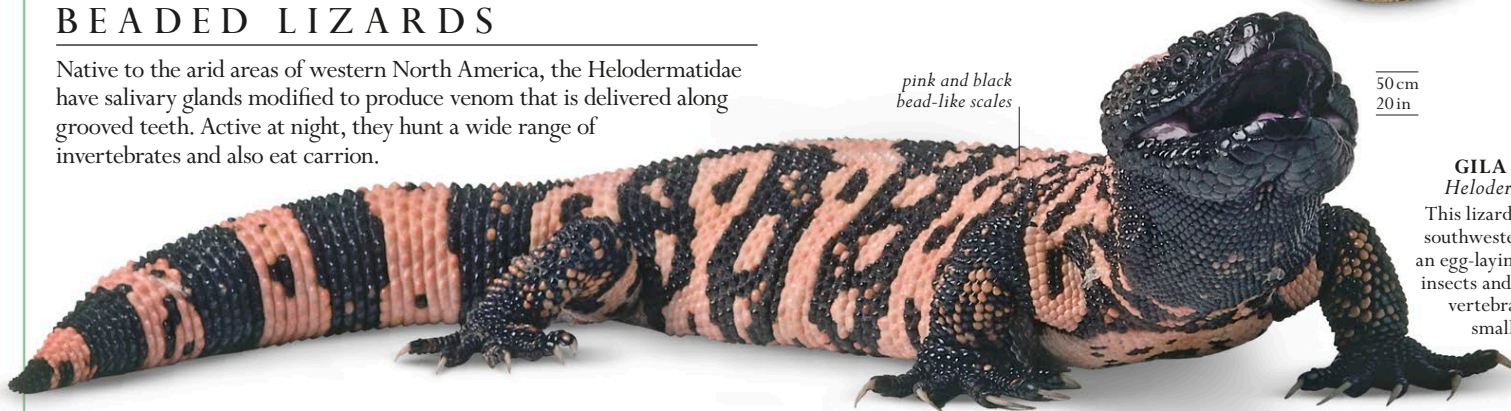
CALIFORNIA LEGLESS LIZARD

Anniella pulchra

An insectivorous, worm-like lizard, this species burrows in sand or loose soil. It can detach its tail to trick predators.

BEADED LIZARDS

Native to the arid areas of western North America, the Helodermatidae have salivary glands modified to produce venom that is delivered along grooved teeth. Active at night, they hunt a wide range of invertebrates and also eat carrion.



50 cm
20 in

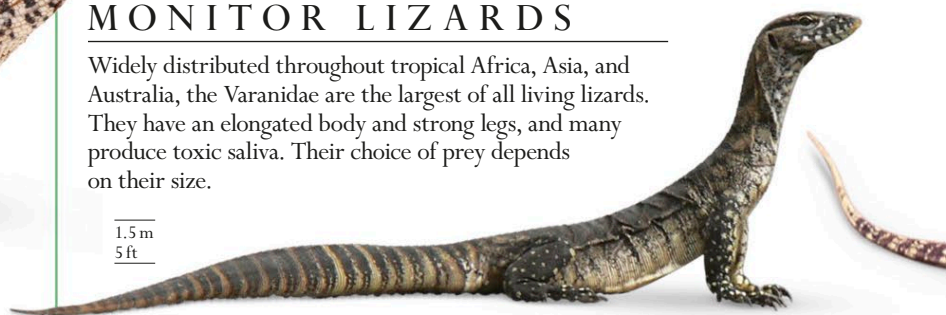
GILA MONSTER

Heloderma suspectum

This lizard of the deserts of southwestern N. America is an egg-laying species. It hunts insects and ground-dwelling vertebrates, including small mammals.

MONITOR LIZARDS

Widely distributed throughout tropical Africa, Asia, and Australia, the Varanidae are the largest of all living lizards. They have an elongated body and strong legs, and many produce toxic saliva. Their choice of prey depends on their size.



1.5 m
5 ft

HEATH MONITOR

Varanus rosenbergi

Found around the coasts of southern Australia, this monitor has a varied diet. It is a strong digger and often forages underground for food.



2 m
6½ ft

ASIAN WATER MONITOR

Varanus salvator

This monitor is found in rainforests and wet habitats of S. Asia. Its large size allows it to tackle a variety of prey.

SAVANNA MONITOR

Varanus exanthematicus

Found in the savanna of sub-Saharan Africa, this species forages for invertebrates and other animals small enough to swallow.

1.3 m
4¼ ft

long,
sinuous tail

ANGUID LIZARDS

The Anguidae include both legless forms and species with normal limbs. Most lizards are surface dwellers and occur in a range of habitats in the Old and New Worlds. Though often insectivorous, these lizards will feed on a range of prey. They lay eggs.



48 cm
19 in

SLOW WORM

Anguis fragilis

A legless lizard found in well-vegetated habitats across Europe, this species favours compost heaps, where it preys on invertebrates.

EUROPEAN GLASS LIZARD

Pseudopus apodus

Found in the dry habitats of S. Europe, this legless lizard hunts during the day for large insects and small lizards.

1.2 m
4 ft

